Step 3: Order of Installation

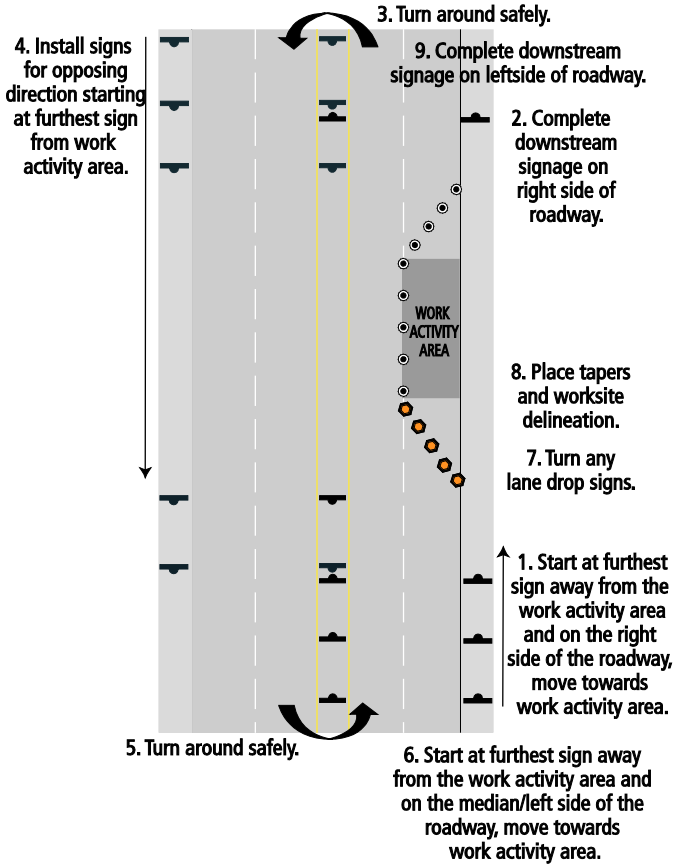
Traffic control devices should be placed in the order that drivers will encounter them, beginning with the sign or device farthest upstream from the work activity area and continuing towards the work area. Typically, channelizing devices forming lane shifts, merges, detours, and other traffic pattern changes are established after the signs identifying the work zone are in place.

In a multilane setup, regardless of which lane has the work activity area, the signs on the right side of the roadway should be installed first because drivers typically look to the right side for direction information.

Start upstream from the work area, on the right shoulder, and in the same direction as the flow of traffic, place signs in the previously marked locations. Keep as far off the travel lane as possible.

For a right lane closure:

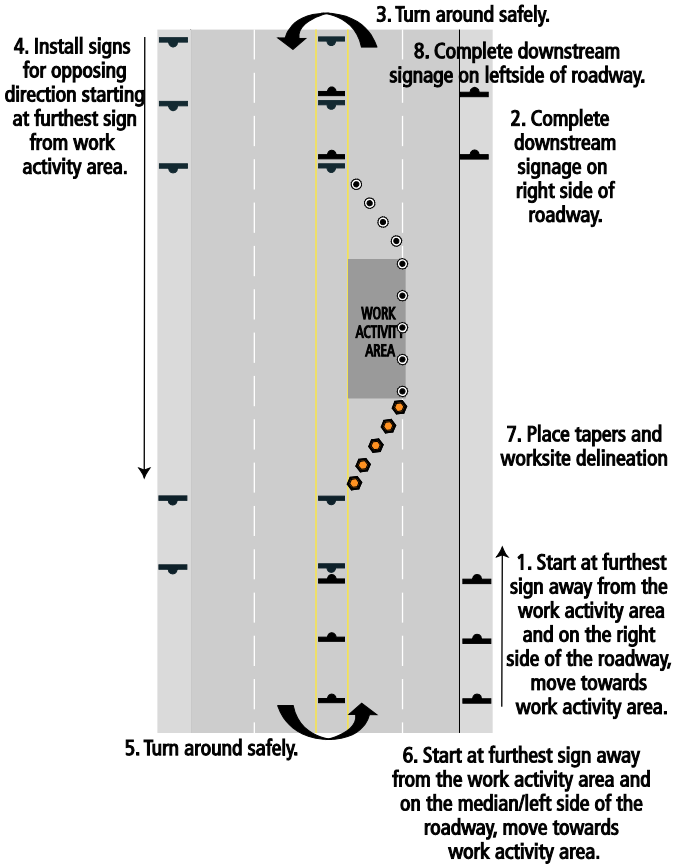
1. Place the advance warning signs on the right shoulder, starting in advance of the work activity area.
    - When placing lane drop signs, keep them turned away from the view of traffic.
    - Cover any existing conflicting signs.
2. Place signs in the termination area.
    - Cover any existing conflicting signs.
3. Turn around using the next appropriate location downstream of the work area to travel in the opposite direction.
4. If signs and devices are required in the opposing direction, repeat items 1 and 2 in the opposite direction, starting in advance of the work activity area.
5. Travel to the next appropriate location upstream of the work area and in advance of the warning signs, and turn around.



6. On the left lane shoulder, set up all required signs for the work activity area, and cover any existing conflicting signs. Repeat sub-steps 3 and 4 as required.
7. Return to the right shoulder and turn the lane drop or directional signage.
8. Place tapers and delineation around the work activity area.
9. Install downstream signs on left side of roadway.

For a left lane closure:

1. Place the advance warning signs on the right shoulder, starting in advance of the work activity area.
    - Cover any existing conflicting signs.
2. Place the signs in the termination area.
    - Cover any existing conflicting signs.
3. Turn around using the next appropriate location downstream of the work area to travel in the opposite direction.
4. If signage and devices are required in the opposing direction, repeat items 1 and 2 in the opposite direction, starting in advance of the work activity area.
5. Travel to the next appropriate location upstream of the work area and in advance of the warning signage, and turn around.



6. On the median, set up all required signage for the work activity area, and cover existing conflicting signs.
7. Place tapers and delineation around the work activity area.
8. Install downstream signs on left side of roadway.

Step 4: Planning the Removal

As soon as the traffic control devices are no longer needed, they should be removed. During the removal process, Traffic Control Persons, flashing arrow boards, shadow vehicles, and/or flashing vehicle lights should be used.

Signs and devices are removed in the opposite order of which they were installed. Traffic Control Person Ahead C-001 signs should remain in place until Traffic Control Persons are no longer needed.

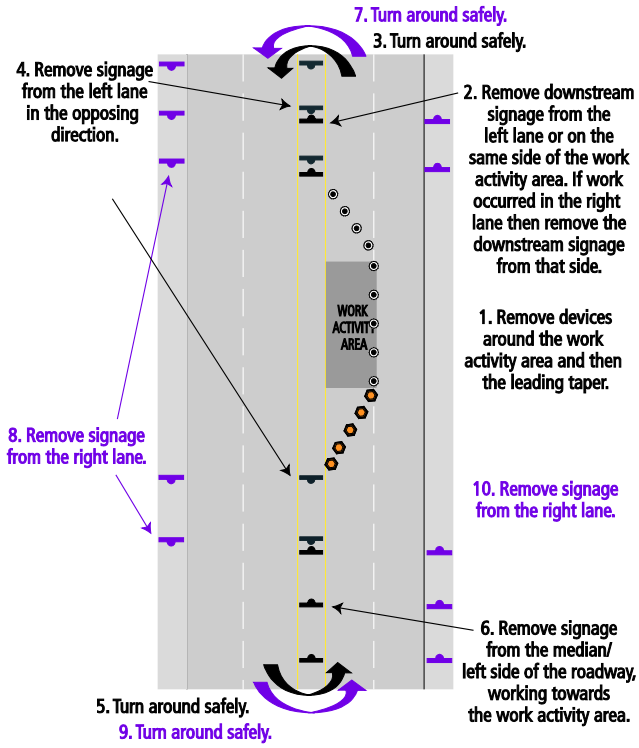
No worker should ride outside on the rear of a reversing vehicle. If special circumstances allow for this practice, it is mandatory to follow WorkSafeBC's Occupational Health and Safety Regulations.

Step 5: Order of Removal

Ensure that work operations have ceased, and that all equipment and workers are off the roadway.

Using the diagram on the right:

1. First remove channelizing devices on the travel lane where the work has occurred. Do not remove advance warning signs until all other devices are removed.
    - Use a TCP to stop traffic, if required, or a buffer vehicle to maintain the closure and direct traffic into the other lane.
    - Pull channelizing devices off the roadway, starting with those closest to the work area on the downstream side and then moving to the upstream side. If necessary, place channelizing devices on the shoulder for storage and later pick-up.
2. Starting downstream of the work activity area, move with the flow of traffic on the same side of the roadway, keeping as far off the travel lane as possible. Pick up or turn signs that are not in use. Uncover any previously covered signs



3. Turn around using an appropriate location downstream of the work area.
4. Moving with the flow of traffic, remove signs and devices in the opposing direction.

   Remove or turn signs not in use on the median/left shoulder first (if they are set up there), and then remove those not in use on the right shoulder.
5. Turn around using an appropriate location.
6. Working towards the work activity area and moving with the flow of traffic, remove or turn signs not in use on the median/left shoulder. Uncover any previously covered signs.
7. Turn around using an appropriate location downstream of the work area.
8. Moving with the flow of traffic, remove or turn signage not in use on the right shoulder in the opposing direction. Uncover any previously covered signs.
9. Turn around using an appropriate location.
10. Moving with the flow of traffic, remove or turn any remaining signage on the right shoulder. Uncover any previously covered signs.

6.8 Inspection and Maintenance of Traffic Control

Traffic control devices shall be routinely inspected and maintained during both active and inactive work to ensure that they are not missing, and that they are clean, properly positioned, and effective in all weather and light conditions. Inspection and maintenance shall occur on all projects, regardless of size or complexity.

6.8.1 Responsibility for Inspection and Maintenance

Maintenance of traffic control is the responsibility of the Prime Contractor. Once the work zone is installed, it is important to ensure that it functions as intended, and that any subsequent modifications resulting from an inspection process are documented, implemented and maintained.

For each project, an individual shall be assigned supervisory responsibility for establishing and maintaining traffic control. On construction projects, the Prime Contractor shall designate a specific person (or persons) to assume these responsibilities. Possible candidates for this role include:

- Site Supervisor/Foreman/Superintendent
- Traffic Control Manager
- Traffic Control Supervisor
- Traffic Control Person

Lines of communication and responsibility should be clearly established between individuals in charge of routine maintenance of traffic control devices and those with greater authority so that, when necessary, problems can be brought promptly to the attention of personnel or authorities who are in a position to respond immediately.

6.8.2 Elements of Inspection and Maintenance

Inspection and maintenance of traffic control should include:

- devices are installed as per the traffic control plan
- review sign and device placement, condition, cleanliness, height, offset
- review of the functionality of the traffic control layouts during day and night and in all weather conditions
- all hazards within the work zone are addressed and mitigated
- traffic control devices no longer need are covered or removed

Maintenance, servicing, or replacement of temporary traffic control devices and equipment may be required due to:

- traffic incidents
- damage caused by construction activities
- dead/low flashing light batteries or burned out bulbs
- low fuel levels for electrical generators
- weather damage, wear and tear
- dirt on devices
- vandalism or theft

6.8.3 Field Inspection Frequency

The frequency of field inspections should be based on the following:

- project size and duration
- nature of the work activity
- complexity of traffic control
- frequency at which damage occurs
- number of problems observed in previous inspections

Traffic control that is required and left in place overnight should be inspected during hours of darkness.

Inspections should be continued day and night and through holidays, weekends, and other times when work is not active.

6.9 Work Duration

Work duration is the length of time work occupies one or multiple locations. It is a major factor in determining the number and types of temporary traffic control devices to be used in a work activity area.

There are five types of work based on work duration:

1. **Emergent work** is work that occurs when an unanticipated situation or event is discovered during travel or work. It can be carried out in less than 5 minutes. This does not include emergencies, which are situations which require immediate response to save lives or prevent serious injury using whatever resources are available
2. **Brief-duration work** is generally planned work that requires a quick response and can be carried out in less than 15 minutes.
3. **Mobile work** is continuously slow-moving work or intermittently-moving work, with short stops of 30 minutes or less. The traffic control devices for mobile work are typically vehicle-mounted.
4. **Short-duration work** occurs when a work operation occupies one location for more than 15 minutes during a single daylight period.
5. **Long-duration work** is planned construction work that occupies one location for more than one daylight period. Night work lasting more than 15 minutes is also considered long-duration work.

6.10 Risk Evaluation for Emergent and Brief-Duration Work

Emergent and brief-duration work may have limited advance warning because of the type of work being done and the limited duration of that work.

Layouts specific to emergent work and brief-duration work are provided in:

- *Section 7: Traffic Control Layouts – Two-Lane, Two-Way Roadways*
- *Section 8: Traffic Control Layouts – Multilane Undivided Roadways*
- *Section 9: Traffic Control Layouts – Multilane Divided Roadways*

Other layouts such as those for short-duration and long-duration work may also be used if appropriate.

A **Risk Evaluation** shall be performed using *Table C – Risk Evaluation for Emergent or Brief-Duration* (see next page or *Appendix F*) to determine if emergent or brief-duration work is permissible. If emergent or brief-duration work is not permissible, other layouts should be considered to complete the work.

TABLE C – RISK EVALUATION FOR EMERGENT OR BRIEF-DURATION WORK

<table>
<tr><th>Risk Evaluation Category</th><th>Risk Criteria</th><th>Criteria Met?</th></tr>
<tr><td>1. Work Duration</td><td>Can the work be completed in 5 minutes or less?</td><td>Yes / No</td></tr>
<tr><td>2. Sight Distance
Distance from parked location to furthest point that can be seen on the road.</td><td>For the posted speed limit, is the minimum sight distance met?
<table><tr><th>Speed Limit (km/h)</th><th>50 - 70</th><th>80 - 90</th><th>100 - 110</th><th>120</th></tr><tr><td>Minimum Sight Distance (m)</td><td>100</td><td>170</td><td>250</td><td>300</td></tr></table></td><td>Yes / No</td></tr>
<tr><td>3. Traffic Volume</td><td>Is the traffic volume in lanes that will be entered by workers estimated to be less than 5 vehicles per lane per minute?</td><td>Yes / No</td></tr>
<tr><td>4. Environmental Conditions</td><td>Is visibility unrestricted (no fog, blowing snow, etc.) and are road conditions not slippery?</td><td>Yes / No</td></tr>
</table>

RISK EVALUATION REVIEW

The Risk Evaluation has three possible outcomes:

1. **Answers to all risk criteria questions are Yes:** Traffic control devices may be installed in accordance with the appropriate Emergent Work traffic control layout.

2. **Answers to one or two risk criteria questions are No**: Traffic control devices may be installed in accordance with the appropriate Brief-Duration Work traffic control layout**.**

3. **Answers to three or more risk criteria questions are No:** Additional traffic control measures are required beyond those described and illustrated for Emergent and Brief-Duration Work. The standard layout(s) for the appropriate short-duration, long-duration, or mobile work should be applied.

6.11 Using Sections 7 to 19

The traffic control layouts in Sections 7 to 19 are generally the minimum required. These layouts do not represent every work activity that could occur on the roadway. Standards may be modified using expert judgment. The principles outlined in this manual shall always be followed.

6.11.1 Information in Sections 7 to 19

Sections 7 to 19 provide the following information about traffic control layouts:

- basic traffic control principles, situations, and methods
- prescribed traffic control standards for work zones
- guidance and options related to the prescribed standards

Each section begins with a general description which applies to the layouts.

6.11.2 Application of Sections 7 to 19

1. Descriptions on the Left

The descriptions on the left provide the layout information:

Purpose: Intended use of the layout.

Standard: Uses words such as **shall, required, must** - describes a mandatory condition. For provincial highways, if a mandatory condition cannot be met, contact Traffic and Highway Safety Engineering - Policy and Standards for direction.

Guidance: Uses words such as **should, recommended** - describes a recommended, but not mandatory, practice. Decisions contrary to guidance are required to be documented (example of "should" documentation can be found on the next page).

The primary information to be documented by the Prime Contractor include:

- What is the decision?
- When was it made?
- Why was it made?
- Who made it?
- Other information may be included and may vary based on the scope of the change(s).

Options: Uses words such as **may** - describes a permissive condition. It is optional and carries no requirement or recommendation.

"SHOULD" DOCUMENTATION

The following is an example of written documentation for not following a "should" condition.

Scenario
A Contractor was completing a survey on the shoulder for only a couple hours. The Contractor requested permission to install construction signs on only one side of the road (shoulder) even though median barrier and/or depressed median was available at the location to place signs. On multilane highways where median barrier exists, Ministry guidelines state that signs should be placed.

The Contractor's justification was they were only going to be out in the field for a single day, working only on the shoulder and right-of-way, during the daytime, for a length of a couple (2-3) hours. The Contractor was of the opinion that installation of the signs themselves (on the median) increases worker exposure and road user exposure to risks. That in itself would not have been enough justification for the Ministry to accept their traffic management plan proposal. However, combined with the type of work, location, and duration, for what amounted to a very short period of time, especially when the work did not impact available lanes for vehicle movements, the Ministry agreed and accepted their proposal.

Documentation
The Contractor provided the following details in their "should" documentation:

1) Summary of proposal/request
2) Project name, location and date of proposed work
3) Overview of work to be completed and explanation of scenario
4) Justification of request including the following details:
    - Survey work
    - Shoulder work only
    - One-time occurrence
    - Day time work
    - Only 2-3 hours on shoulder
    - Installing signs on the median has risks in itself to both workers and road users during the period of time signs being installed and removed. Lane travel was not impacted by Contractor's survey work taking place on shoulder, and Ministry right-of-way.
5) Contact person

2. Diagrams on the Right

The diagrams on the right show all standards associated to the traffic control layout. There will be information in the diagram that is not described.

6.11.3 General Instructions for Using the Layouts in Sections 7 to 19

1. The diagrams are not drawn to scale. *Table A – Taper Lengths* and *Table B – Device Spacing Lengths* shall be used to determine appropriate spacing dimensions.
2. Most of the layouts may be used for both day-time and night-time work.
3. Lighting locations are not shown in the diagrams but Traffic Control Persons shall be illuminated with overhead lighting at night.
4. To determine the appropriate sign size and lateral placement for the roadway, see *Section 4.2: Traffic Signs.*
5. Speeds on regulatory signs are shown as "XX" to allow for various speeds.
6. The layouts show only one set of advance signage in each direction. See *Section 6.4 Queue Management* for more information.
7. Some road features, sight lines, intersections, and other conditions may make it necessary to adjust sign spacing. In these cases, signs should be placed in the most reasonable location that provides good visibility for drivers and enough time for them to make appropriate adjustments.
8. Buffer spaces may not be identified in all the layouts. Where space allows and it is considered desirable, a buffer space should be included, even when it is not indicated on the typical layout or in the Traffic Control Plan.

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PART B – TRAFFIC CONTROL

Section 7: Traffic Control Layouts – Two-Lane, Two-Way Roadways

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PART B – TRAFFIC CONTROL

Section 7: Traffic Control Layouts – Two-Lane, Two-Way Roadways

LEGEND			
	Flexible Drum		Paint Truck
	Tubular Marker		Escort Truck
	Cone		Chaser Vehicle
	Sign		Vehicle Mounted Rear Crash Attenuator
	Traffic Control Person		
	Work Activity Area		360° Flashing Light
	Work Truck		Portable Traffic Signal
	Shadow Vehicle		Barricade and Fencing
	Shadow Vehicle #1		Flashing Arrow Board (FAB)
	Shadow Vehicle #2		Flashing Arrow Board (FAB) in caution mode
	Buffer Vehicle		Dynamic Message Sign (DMS)

TABLE A – TAPER LENGTHS

Taper Types (m)		Regular Posted Speed Limit (km/h)							
		≤50	60	70	80	90	100	110	120
Merge Taper Length	L_M	35	55	160	190	210	230	250	280
Lane Shift Taper Length	L_L	30	50	80	100	110	120	130	140
Downstream Taper Length	L_D	30	30	30	30	30	30	30	30
TCP, Signal, and Shoulder Taper Length (min. 5 devices)	L_S	5	8	15	15	15	15	15	15
Minimum Tangent Length between Tapers	L_T	30	60	160	190	210	230	250	280
Run-In Length on Centreline	L_R	40	50	60	60	70	80	90	100

TABLE B – DEVICE SPACING LENGTHS

Device Spacing (m)		Regular Posted Speed Limit (km/h)							
		≤50	60	70	80	90	100	110	120
Construction Sign Spacing	A	40	60	80	100	150	150	200	200
Buffer Space	B	30	40	60	80	110	140	170	200
Roll-Ahead Buffer Distance	R	30	30	40	40	40	50	50	50
Channelizing Device Spacing for Tapers	C	10	10	15	15	15	15	15	15
Channelizing Device Spacing on Curves and Tangents	D	10	10	30	30	40	40	40	50

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7.1 General Information – Two-Lane, Two-Way Roadways

The traffic control layouts are considered the minimum standard. The associated text description of each figure highlights the key standards as well as guidance and options that can be considered by the user. The following information is typical on most layouts in this section:

Standard:

- For short-duration work, a Crew Working Ahead C-004 sign shall be used.
- For long-duration work, a Construction Ahead C-018-1A sign shall be used.
- Where the speed limit is ≥ 70 km/h, a buffer space shall be used.
- All work, buffer, and shadow vehicles shall be equipped with a 360-degree flashing light and 4-way flashers.

Guidance:

- Where the speed limit is ≥ 70 km/h a buffer vehicle should be used when workers are present.
- A vehicle-mounted crash attenuator is recommended for use on buffer vehicles.

Options:

- Where cyclists are regularly observed using the shoulder, a Share the Road W-132-1 sign may be used with an appropriate cycling hazard tab (see *Section 18: Traffic Control Layouts – Bicycle Lanes* for additional information).
- A portable dynamic message sign (DMS) may be used to provide advance messaging for drivers.
- In low speed (≤ 60 km/h) urban areas (within municipal boundaries), customization of traffic control layouts, including closer device spacing and shorter taper lengths, may be necessary to maintain access and mobility. In these cases, document why adjustments are being made.

7.2 Typical Construction Speed Zone Signing – Two-Lane, Two-Way Roadway

Purpose:

Construction speed limits are regulatory speeds established in Construction Speed Zones within long-term construction and maintenance project areas where there are continuous hazards for motorists or where workers are in close proximity to active travel lanes.

Construction Speed Zones should be applied prudently because **overuse reduces effectiveness.** Drivers should be able to perceive the need to reduce speed.

Standard:

- Conflicting speed limit signs within the Construction Speed Zone shall be covered or removed.
- The same Construction Speed Zone signing is required in opposing directions.

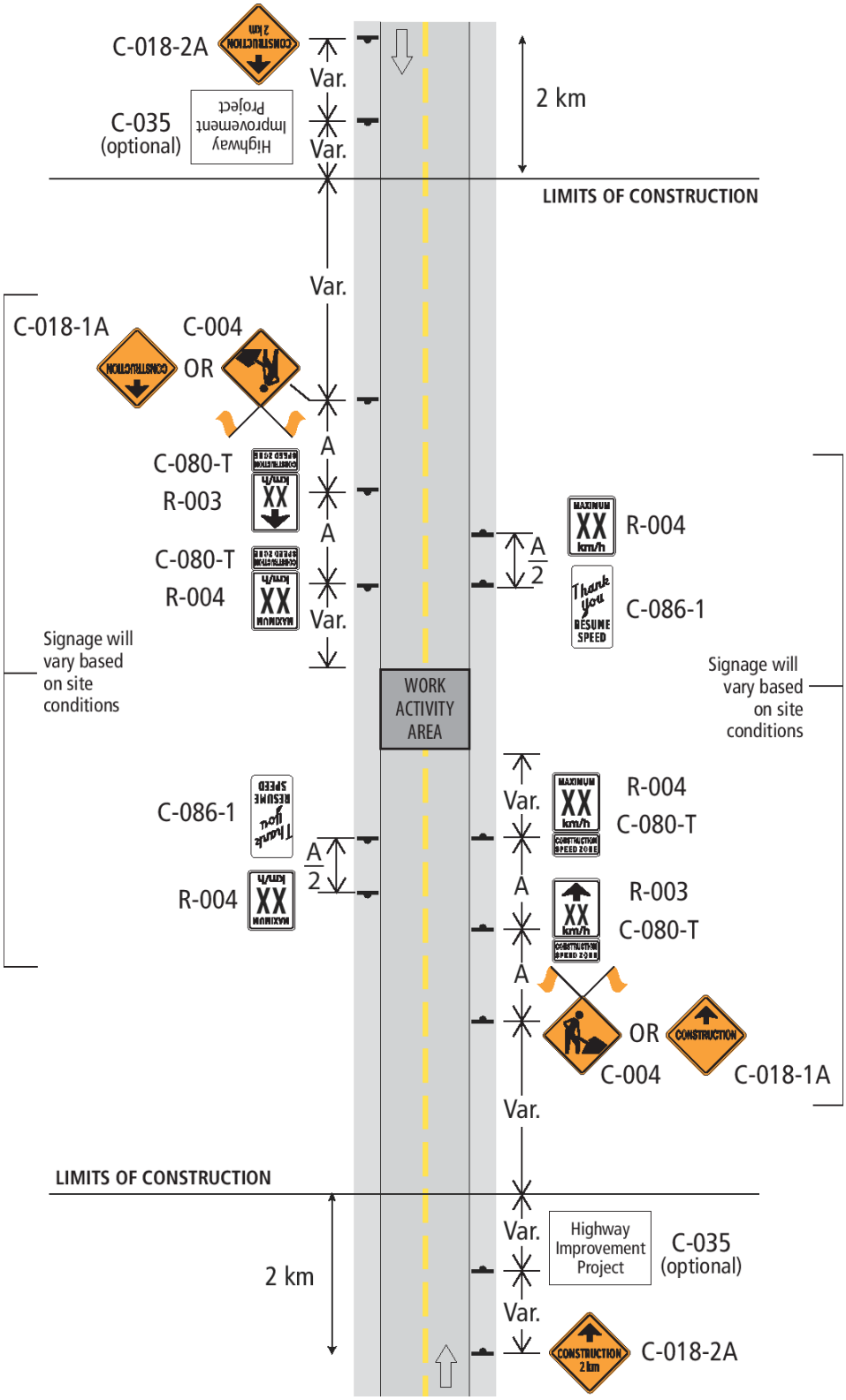
Guidance:

- The Maximum Speed R-004 sign with a Construction Speed Zone C-080-T distance tab should be positioned at the beginning of the active work area.
- Construction speed limit signs should be covered or removed when no work is occurring and other hazards are not present.
- It is important to record when construction speed limits are installed and covered/removed.
- See also *Section 2.4: Management of Speed* for information on using Construction Speed Zones.

Options:

- Use of the Construction Project C-035 sign is project-dependent. It is typically used only for large projects. See *Appendix B: Standard Construction Signs* for information on using this sign.
- If secondary signs are applied, they should be installed on the left side of the highway.
- The positioning of secondary signs depends on the space available:
  - If the median is more than 2 metres wide, secondary signs may be placed in the median.
  - If the median is less than 2 metres wide, secondary signs may be placed on the opposite shoulder.

Figure 7.2: Typical Construction Speed Zone Signing – Two-Lane, Two-Way Roadway



7.3 Emergent Work (<5 Minutes) – Two-Lane, Two-Way Roadway

Purpose:

Emergent work involves very short-duration activities for which setting up and taking down temporary traffic control devices may take more time than the actual work, and expose workers to greater risk. Each entry onto the travelled portion of the roadway lasts less than 1 minute, and the total time to complete the task is less than 5 minutes.

This does not include emergencies, which are situations which require immediate response to save lives or prevent serious injury using whatever resources are available.

It may occur when an unanticipated situation or event—one that presents a risk to the travelling public—is discovered during travel or work activities. It can be considered unplanned, urgent maintenance work. A Traffic Control Plan is not required for emergent work.

Emergent work may include the removal of debris from the roadway (e.g., tree limbs, lost cargo, dead animals, tire and other vehicle debris, and the manual removal of rock). Isolated pothole patching—patching 1 or 2 potholes in a 1-kilometre section of road—may be considered emergent or brief-duration work. However, it is mobile work when the work crew has to stop several times in succession within a 1-kilometre section to patch multiple potholes.

Standard:

- A risk evaluation is required to determine whether or not the work activity is considered emergent (see *Table C – Risk Evaluation for Emergent or Brief-Duration Work* in *Section 6.10* or *Appendix F*).
- The entire work activity shall be completed in less than 5 minutes.
- The work vehicle shall use a flashing arrow board (FAB) in caution mode or a 360-degree flashing light and 4-way flashers.

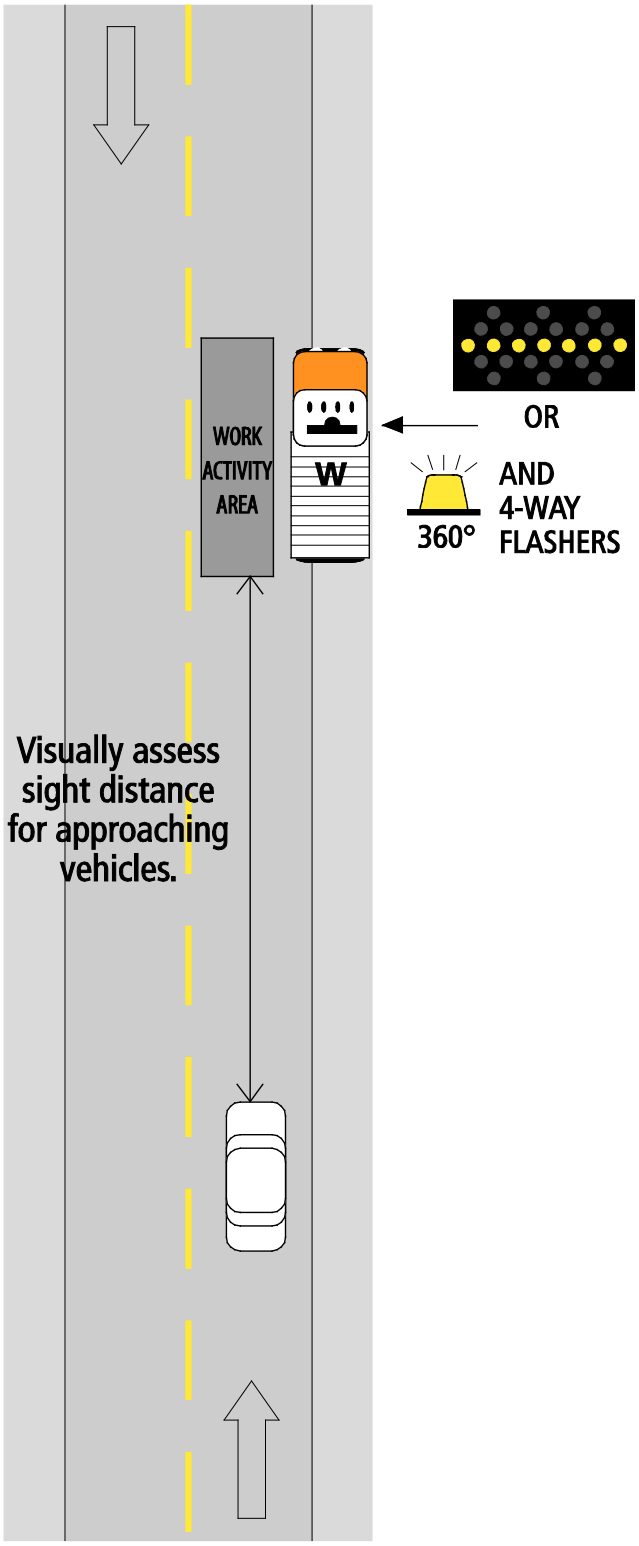
Guidance:

- If a dynamic message sign (DMS) or flashing arrow board (FAB) is used for an operation on the shoulder, it should be set to caution mode.
- The position of the work vehicle in relation to the work area may be adjusted based on the available sight distance, shoulder/off-roadway conditions, and work being performed.

Options:

- None at this time.

Figure 7.3: Emergent Work – Two-Lane, Two-Way Roadway



7.4 Brief-Duration Work (<15 Minutes) – Two-Lane, Two-Way Roadway

Purpose:

Brief-duration work is generally planned, although the exact location or extent of the work required may not be fully known. It requires less than 15 minutes to complete.

Brief-duration work may include:

- locating drainage structures or other roadway features or components
- cleanup of material spills and removing debris from the roadway (e.g., small fallen trees, larger tree limbs, crash debris, etc.)
- quick repairs intended as a partial or temporary response to damage or failure

If the work is expected to last more than 15 minutes, additional resources will be needed to implement a short-duration work zone. The work should be delayed until the appropriate work zone equipment and devices are available.

Isolated pothole patching—patching 1 or 2 potholes in a 1-kilometre section of road—may be considered emergent or brief-duration work. However, it is mobile work when the work crew has to stop several times in succession within a 1-kilometre section to patch multiple potholes.

Standard:

- A Crew Working Ahead C-004 is required in advance of the work.
- A risk evaluation is required to determine whether or not the work activity is considered brief (see *Table C – Risk Evaluation for Emergent or Brief-Duration Work* in *Section 6.10* or *Appendix F*).
- The work activity shall be completed in less than 15 minutes.
- The work vehicle shall use a flashing arrow board (FAB) in caution mode or a 360-degree flashing light and 4-way flashers.

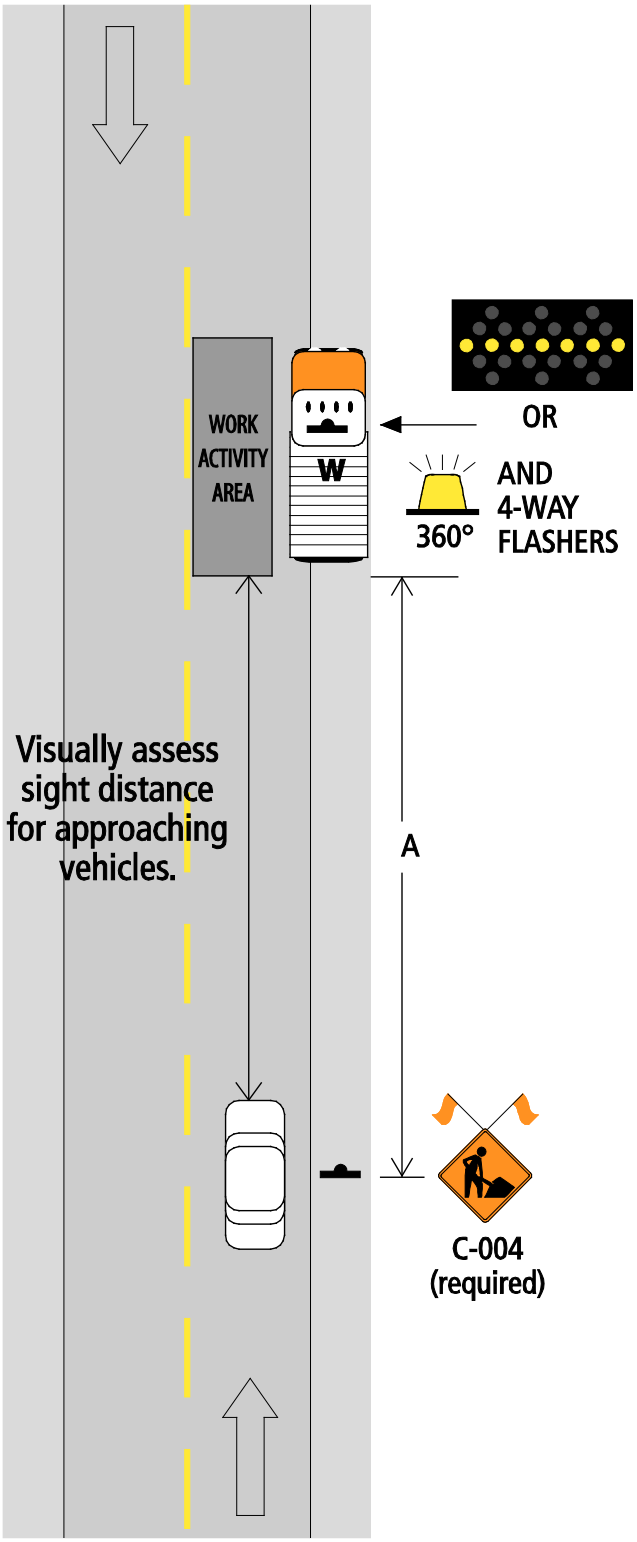
Guidance:

- If a dynamic message sign (DMS) or flashing arrow board (FAB) is used for an operation on the shoulder, it should be set to caution mode.
- The position of the work vehicle in relation to the work area may be adjusted based on the available sight distance, shoulder/off-roadway conditions, and the work being performed.

Options:

- None at this time.

Figure 7.4: Brief-Duration Work – Two-Lane, Two-Way Roadway



7.5 Work on Shoulder – Short and Long Duration

Purpose:

Stationary work on the shoulder takes place outside the travel lanes but occupies part or all of the shoulder area.

If shoulder work encroaches into a travel lane, a full lane closure may have to be implemented.

Standard:

- When work is in progress and workers are present, a flashing arrow board (FAB) in caution mode is required in the taper or immediately in advance of the work area.
- Barricades are required at each end of the work activity area for long-duration work.

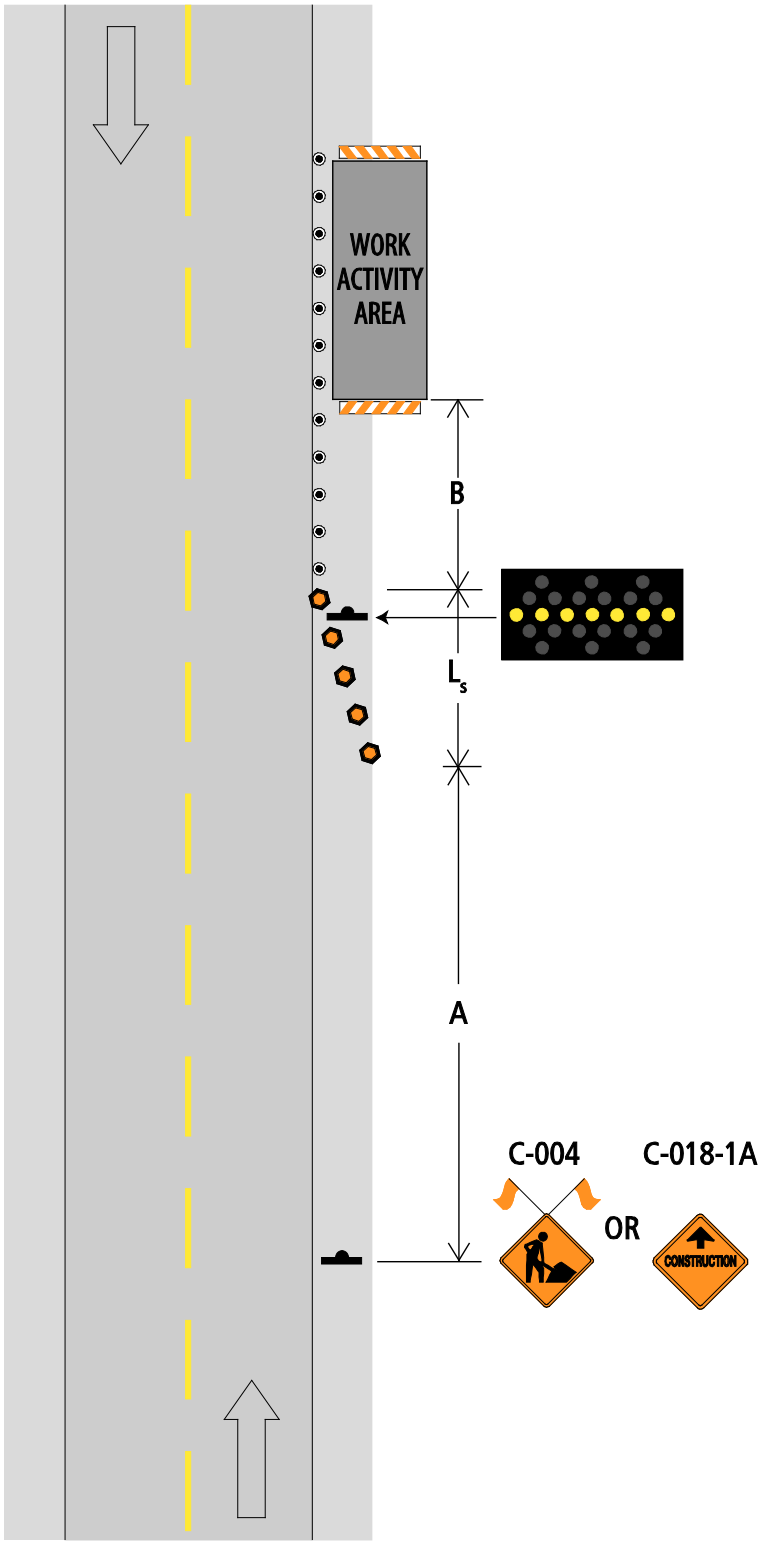
Guidance:

- When work is not in progress but the work area has not been cleared, care should be taken to isolate it from the travelled lane.

Options:

- Advance warning signs may be installed in the opposing direction of travel.
- If the speed limit is ≤ 60 km/h, or there is insufficient room, tubular markers may replace drums for the taper.
- The channelizing devices used alongside the work area may be tubular markers or cones.
- Advance warning signs may be omitted for short-duration work if a shadow vehicle displays a vehicle-mounted dynamic message sign (DMS) or flashing arrow board (FAB) in caution mode.

Figure 7.5: Work on Shoulder – Short and Long Duration



7.6 Work in Parking Lane – Urban Area

Purpose:

This layout is used where a parking lane is closed for construction or maintenance activities.

Standard:

- Advance warning signs shall not be obscured by vehicles or other devices.
- If the parking lane is normally open to vehicle travel at various times of day (such as rush hour) and closed to vehicle travel during other times of the day, the lane shall be considered a travel lane, not a parking lane, and a lane closure shall be implemented.

Guidance:

- The closed parking area should be delineated with cones or tubular markers.
- Advance notice of the parking restriction should be installed to ensure an unoccupied work activity area, and may include:
  - covering parking meters;
  - installing no parking signs; and/or
  - using cones to cordon off the area.

Options:

- The Crew Working Ahead C-004 sign may be used within the parking lane if space allows, or placed on the sidewalk as long as it does not impede pedestrians.
- A work vehicle may be parked in advance of the work activity area with a flashing arrow board (FAB).